

Setting up your Groq API key

A step-by-step guide for using the Brightspace quiz generators for Mathematics and Language Arts

Dear colleague,

The Brightspace quiz generators (Mathematics and Language Arts) run on the Llama 3.3 70B artificial intelligence model through an API provided by a company called Groq. To use these tools, each instructor needs a personal key of their own, called an **API key**. It is completely free. The whole process takes under five minutes and asks for no credit card and no financial information of any kind.

Why do I need my own key?

An API key works like a digital ID card: it authorises the generator to talk to the artificial intelligence servers on your behalf. Using a personal key gives you three things:

- **Privacy.** Your key is stored only in your own browser (local storage). It is never sent to the author's servers or to the college's.
- **Independence.** You manage your own usage, without depending on a shared quota that someone else might use up.
- **Security.** If you ever want to revoke access, you can do it from your own account without affecting anyone else.

Free of charge

Groq's free tier gives you a generous daily allowance — far more than ordinary classroom quiz writing requires. Under normal teaching use you should never need to pay for this service.

How to get your key

Follow the four steps below. Each one takes less than a minute.

1

Open the Groq portal

Open your browser (Chrome, Firefox or Safari) and go to this address:

<https://console.groq.com/keys>

You can also search Google for “Groq Console” and click the first result.

2

Create your free account

On the main page you will see **Sign up with Google** and **Sign up with GitHub**, along with a form for signing up by email. Signing in with your Google account is the fastest route — one click and you are registered. You will not be asked for a credit card at any point.

3

Create a new API key

Once you are inside the dashboard, look for the **Create API Key** button. You will be asked for a descriptive name so you can identify the key later; something like “GED Generator Truman” works well. Then click **Submit**.

4

Copy the key right away

A long key will appear, starting with gsk_ followed by many characters. Copy the whole thing with the **Copy** button or by selecting it with your mouse. **This matters:** Groq shows you the key only once. If you close the window without copying it, you will have to generate a new one.

Treat your key like a password

Handle your key the way you would handle your email password: do not share it with anyone, do not post it on a website, and do not send it through public channels. If you suspect someone else has seen it, you can revoke it at any time from the Groq portal and generate a new one.

Entering the key into the generator

Once the key is on your clipboard, open either generator (Mathematics or Language Arts) from GEDparaHispanos.com and follow these steps:

5

Find the configuration button

In the top right corner of the generator you will find a button with a gear icon labelled **Configure API**. If this is the first time you have opened the generator, that panel opens by itself, so you will not have to go looking for it.

6

Paste your key into the field

In the panel that opens, find the heading **Paste your key here** and paste your key with Ctrl+V (Windows) or Cmd+V (Mac). For security the characters appear as dots. If you want to check that you pasted the right thing, use the **Show/Hide** button.

7

Save the key

Click **Save key**. The tool checks that the key has the right shape (it must begin with gsk_) and shows you a confirmation in green: *Key saved successfully. You can now generate questions.* If instead you see a message in red saying the key must start with gsk_, the key was probably copied incompletely — go back to the Groq portal and copy it again.

8

Close the panel and start working

Close the panel with the × in the top right corner or by pressing Esc. You can now use the generator normally. The key stays saved in your browser, so you will not have to paste it again each time.

One key, both Brightspace generators

The key you save in the Mathematics generator is picked up automatically by the Language Arts generator, as long as you open both in the same browser. There is no need to configure it twice. The MyOpenMath generator is a separate tool and keeps its own copy, so if you use that one as well, paste the same key there once.

Frequently asked questions

Does the key disappear when I close the browser?

No. It stays in the browser permanently until you delete it yourself with the **Delete saved key** button, or until you clear your browsing data from the browser's own settings. It survives shutting the computer down.

Do I have to set up the key on every computer I use?

Yes. Because the key lives in the browser, if you use the generator on the classroom computer and again at home, you will need to enter it in both places. The same key works on all your devices.

What happens if I go over Groq's free limit?

Groq limits how much you can send in a single minute and in a single day. If you go over, you will see an error saying the quota has been exhausted. Waiting a minute (or a few hours, for the daily limit) is enough for the counter to reset. Nothing is charged automatically and no payment method is on file.

Can my students or other instructors see my key?

No. The key is stored only in your browser and is never passed to other users. If you share the generator's link with your students, they will see the form asking them to configure a key of their own, but they will never have access to yours.

Can I use the same key for other generators released later?

Yes. Any tool the author builds on GEDparaHispanos.com that uses the Groq API can share the same key stored in your browser.

If I lose the key, can I recover it?

A lost key cannot be recovered. You can, however, generate a new one at any time from the Groq portal by repeating steps 1 to 4 of this guide.

The generator says access was denied. What now?

That message usually means a network is blocking `api.groq.com` rather than anything being wrong with your key. Some campus networks and some VPNs do this. Try the same file from a home connection or a phone hotspot with the VPN switched off; if it works there, the block was on the network.

Technical support

If you run into trouble during setup, or the generator does not behave the way this guide describes, please get in touch with the author of the resource for individual help.

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